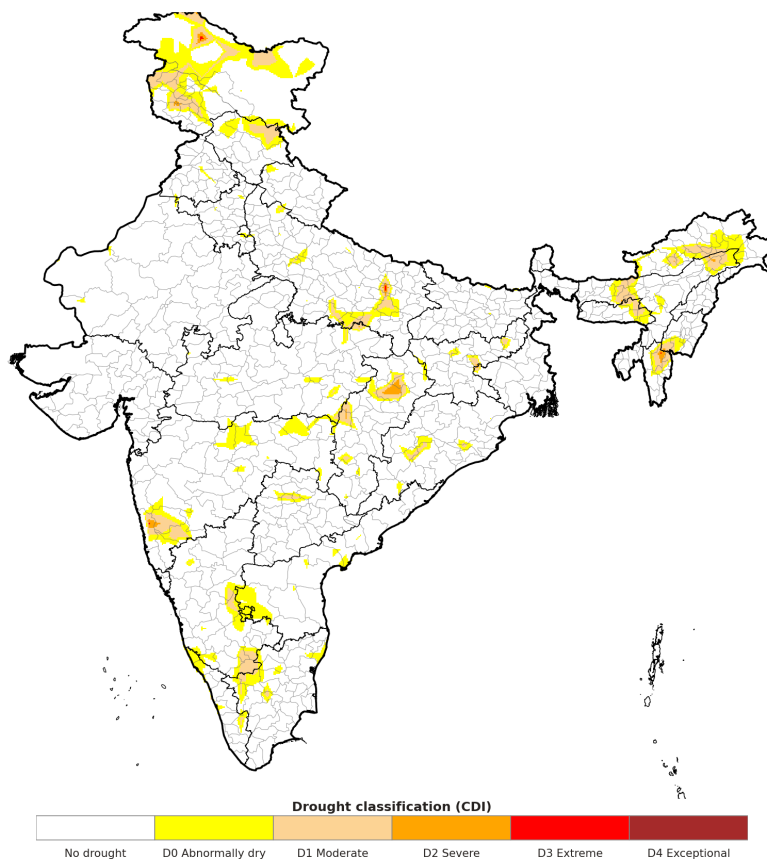




Combined Drought Index (CDI) for the week ending May 20, 2026.

Summary

The national drought situation this week is characterized by a large area remaining in the Normal category, with a smaller proportion experiencing drought conditions. The total area affected by drought, specifically D0 and above, was 15.3% this week. This represents a contraction in the drought area compared to the previous week, as the figure was 16.2% last week. Looking further back, the area was 17.2% approximately one month ago, indicating a contraction of 0.9 percentage points week-on-week. The states most affected by drought across any class were NCT of Delhi, Arunachal Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, Manipur, Mizoram, and Meghalaya. Conversely, Sikkim, Nagaland, Tripura, and West Bengal were among the least affected states, showing 0.0% in drought.

Regional Outlook

North Moderate, scattered drought. About 28% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).

Northwest Largely normal conditions. About 4% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).

Northeast Moderate, scattered drought. About 27% of the area is in drought (D0–D4). Pockets of severe-or-worse conditions are present.

East Mostly normal, with localised dryness. About 7% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).

Central Mostly normal, with localised dryness. About 15% of the area is in drought (D0–D4). Pockets of severe-or-worse conditions are present.

West Moderate, scattered drought. About 22% of the area is in drought (D0-D4).

South Mostly normal, with localised dryness. About 16% of the area is in drought (D0-D4).